Year 3 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Same content as version 1. Use with `Y03/Y03_Student_Booklet_v3.1`; do not mix versions.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y03_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

Who this is for. Children applying for Year 3 are usually 7 years old on 1 September. A child from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 1** (一年级): numbers to 100, adding and subtracting within 100, o'clock and half past, yuan and jiao, and simple 2D and 3D shapes. Times tables, division, fractions, cm rulers and time to five minutes usually come later. English as a school subject often starts in Grade 3, so many children have only had English classes outside school; children from bilingual schools may be close to fluent.

How it works. About 55 minutes of tasks, 1:1, plus a welcome and a short break. The child works in the **Student booklet** (11 pages); you lead every task and record the results on the child's grading sheet, Reading front sheet and Interview sheet. Reading uses the shared reading screens. Mark everything the same day and follow Section 5 (Recording the results), which ends with the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

1. At a glance

	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Student booklet	You need
1	Welcome and picture talk (speaking)	2 + 4	Assessor, 1:1	page 1	Section 3.1 of these instructions
2	Listening: follow instructions	5	Assessor, 1:1	page 2	Pencil; coloured pencils: red, yellow, blue, green
3	Early Reading Screen, then Graded Sentence Reading Screen	12	Assessor, 1:1	(shared cards)	Shared cards, Early Reading Screen record sheets and Reading front sheet (instructions in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`); a plain card; the levelled reading books
	Break	3 to 5			Water; a chance to move
4	Maths: Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures)	18	Child writes; you read any question on request	pages 3 to 10	Pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm
5	Writing: the picture story	8	Child writes	page 11	Pencil
6	Short interview and goodbye	8	Assessor, 1:1		Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`) and Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`); paper and crayons
	Total	**about 55**, plus welcome and break			

What to print

For each candidate:

- the Student booklet (A4, single-sided, at actual size; colour if possible, but the emoji pictures are clear in greyscale)
- the grading sheet (`Y03/Y03_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`)
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`)
- the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`)
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`)
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`), completed after the visit
- the Early Reading Screen record sheets (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`): only the sheets you expect to use

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4`)
- the Sentence Reading Guide (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`)
- the laminated Graded Sentence Reading Screen card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`)
- the laminated Early Reading Screen cards (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`) and guide (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`)
- the levelled reading books
- the equipment in the "You need" column of the table above

2. Before you start

The room. Quiet and bright, with a low table. Sit beside the child, not opposite. Keep the door open or another adult present. Have the booklet open at page 1 and everything else out of sight.

Pace of speech. Year 3 students are still learning English: speak slowly and clearly, about 120 words a minute, with a pause after each sentence. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared (do not slow down further for a child who finds it hard, and repeat an instruction only where these instructions allow it). The listening recording is paced the same way.

Say: "Hello, [name]. My name is [your name]. I am a teacher here. Today we are going to look at some pictures, listen, read, do some maths and do some writing. Some things are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Just do your best. You can ask me to say things again."

Write the child's name on page 1 if they cannot.

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English tasks: picture talk, listening, reading screens, writing	**Maths**
Reading aloud	Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, or read the reading texts for the child. You may repeat an instruction in English.	Read any question aloud in English, as often as the child asks, and point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the child cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question once in Chinese. Write **L** by the question and list it on the grading sheet. The mark still counts.
Answers	In English only. An answer in Chinese scores 0.	In English only: numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.

Codes. NT not yet taught: the child says they have not learnt it; it scores 0 and is listed on the grading sheet. **L** language support in maths. **R** a listening instruction repeated. Record extra time, a reader or any other access arrangement for a known need on the grading sheet. Wherever these instructions say "note it", write the note in the comment space on the grading sheet.

Keeping the child at ease. Chat for a minute first. Praise effort ("Thank you", "You are working hard"), never right or wrong answers. Do not mark in front of the child. Any child may stop a task when they have done what they can. If the child is upset, tired or very quiet, take a break or stop, and record it on the grading sheet. Never press a distressed child.

3. English

3.1 Speaking: picture talk (4 minutes, booklet page 1)

Say: "Look at these pictures. They tell a story. The girl is Mei. This is her grandpa. Let's talk about the pictures."

The story (for you, not to read aloud): 1. Mei and Grandpa plant a seed in a flower pot. 2. Mei waters the pot and a small plant comes up. 3. It is a very hot day; the plant droops and Mei is sad; Grandpa brings the watering can. 4. The plant has grown into a sunflower taller than Mei; they are happy.

Ask the prompts in order, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Wait about 5 seconds before you move on. You may point to a picture, but do not name things for the child and do not correct their English. Record what the child says on the grading sheet, as exactly as you can.

Step	Say (and point)	Listen for
1 Name	"What can you see?" Point to things: "What is this?"	Single words: sun, flower, pot, seed, plant, water, girl, grandpa; watering can, sunflower
2 Describe	Picture 2: "What is Mei doing?"	"Water"; "She is watering the plant."
3 Feelings and why	Picture 3: "How does Mei feel? Why?"	"Sad"; "because the plant is ill / dying / too hot / needs water"
4 Tell the story	"Now tell me the whole story. Start here." Point to picture 1.	The events in order; then, and, because; past tense (planted, watered, grew); time words (every day, one day, at the end)
5 Predict and connect	"What do you think Mei will do next?" Then: "Do you have plants or flowers at home? Tell me about them."	An idea of their own; talk about their own life

Speaking guide for this task. Use it together with the interview. The speaking band is given on the Interview sheet.

Band	At this age, in this task
A New to English	Silent, points, or names one or two things; may talk in Chinese.
B Early acquisition	Names many things; short phrases ("girl sad", "flower big"); needs the prompts.
C Developing competence	Simple sentences with errors ("She put seed in pot. The flower is grow big."); tells the story with help.
D Competent	Tells the whole story in connected sentences, with some past tense; says why; occasional errors.
E Fluent	Tells the story easily, as a fluent English-speaking 7 year old would: past tense, linking words, feelings, an idea about what happens next.

3.2 Listening: follow instructions (about 5 minutes with the recording, booklet page 2)

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y03/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script.

You need: the park picture (page 2), a pencil, and four coloured pencils (red, yellow, blue, green) on the table.

Say: "Look at this picture. I am going to tell you what to do. Listen carefully, then do it. Sometimes you point with your finger. Sometimes you use your pencil."

How to give it

- Say each instruction **once**, slowly and clearly, about 120 words a minute with a pause after each sentence (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2). Do not point to, look at or gesture towards anything in the picture.
- If the child asks, or does nothing for about 5 seconds, say it **once more** and tick **R** on the grading sheet.
- With the recording, if the child asks, or clearly did not hear, pause, go back to the start of the item (the start times are in the read-me) and play it once more: tick **R** on the grading sheet. Pause the recording while a child is still working on an item.
- Score **1** if the child does everything in the instruction correctly, after the first or the second hearing. Otherwise score **0**. Say "Thank you" after every item, whatever happens.
- **Practice (not scored):** "Point to the cloud." If needed, show the child by pointing yourself, then say it again.
- **Stop** if the child scores 0 on three items in a row. Say: "Well done. That is the end of the listening."

No.	Type	Say exactly	Score 1 if the child
1	One step	"Point to the house."	Points to the house.
2	One step	"Point to the boat."	Points to the boat on the pond.
3	One step	"Draw a circle round the bike."	Draws a ring round the bike (a rough ring is fine).
4	Position: under	"Point to the ball under the bench."	Points to the ball under the bench, not the ball on the seat.
5	Position: next to	"Draw a circle round the cat next to the house."	Rings the cat on the grass next to the house, not the cat in the tree.
6	Position: between	"Point to the bird between the two trees."	Points to the flying bird between the trees, not the bird on the roof.
7	Two steps	"Draw a sun in the sky. Then put a cross on the bench."	Does both: a sun anywhere in the sky (a circle is enough) and a cross on the bench.
8	Two steps	"Colour the big duck yellow, and draw a circle round the small duck."	Does both: some yellow on the big duck (another colour scores 0) and a ring round the small duck.
9	Sequence: before	"Before you draw a circle round the house, draw a line under the boat."	Draws the line under the boat **first**, then rings the house. Watch the order.
10	Condition: if	"Look at the pond. If there are three ducks, draw a fish in the water. If there are not three ducks, draw a flower next to the bench."	Draws a flower next to the bench (either side) and no fish. There are two ducks.

Total: 10 marks (1 for each item).

Band guide: 0 to 2 **A**; 3 to 4 **B**; 5 to 6 **C**; 7 to 8 **D**; 9 to 10 **E**.

What to look for

- Choosing the other ball, cat or bird in items 4 to 6 means the position word (under, next to, between) is not yet known, although the noun is.
- Doing only the last part of items 7 and 8, or doing item 9 in the order heard (house first), is typical of a child whose English is still developing (band C): short instructions are understood, longer ones cannot yet be held in English.
- Many R ticks with correct answers show understanding that is still slow. A child who watches your face for clues may understand less than the score suggests; note it.

3.3 Reading: the shared reading screens (12 minutes)

Use the Early Reading Screen (`shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Cards` and the record sheets in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Record`) with the **Year 3 start point** (Guide, Section 2): start at **Section 1, words 1 to 10** (practice Card 3, then Card 4).

- **If words 1 to 10 are easy** (9 or 10 right, most read without sounding out): skip words 11 to 20 and the letter sounds, and go straight to Section 2. Section 2 is 15 or more: go on to the passages. Section 2 is 12 to 14: the tricky words, then the passages. Section 2 is under 12: go back to words 11 to 20, then the tricky words and the passages.
- **If not:** as Year 2. Finish Section 1 (and Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more), then the letter sounds, the tricky words and the passages.

Then give the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, with the rules in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and the score grid on the Reading front sheet) starting at **Level 2** (sentence 4).

- The instructions for the Early Reading Screen are in `shared/Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`; those for the sentence reading are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`. Follow their scoring and stopping rules. These instructions have no reading task of their own.
- In Years 1 to 3 the **reading band** comes from the Early Reading Screen; the sentence reading screen confirms it (see the Sentence Reading Guide, Section 7).
- Pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese (for example l and r, a light final consonant, an extra vowel at the end of a word) are not reading errors when the word is clearly right.
- Record the reading results on the **Reading front sheet** (the Early Reading Screen summary and the sentence reading results) and give it to the interviewer (Sections 3.5 and 5).

3.4 Writing: the picture story (8 minutes, booklet page 11)

The writing comes after the maths (see Section 1).

Say: "Do you remember the story about Mei and the sunflower? Now write the story. Look at each picture and write about it. Start with 'First'." Point to each frame word and read it once, slowly and clearly: "First ... Then ... Next ... At the end."

- Do not spell words, give vocabulary or correct anything. If the child asks for a spelling, say: "Have a go. Write the sounds you can hear."
- If the child has not started after about a minute, say: "Write a word for each picture." Record "labels" on the grading sheet.
- **Only if the child cannot connect with the pictures at all**, offer a short recount instead: "Write about something you did last weekend." The frame words still help. Record "recount" on the grading sheet.
- Stop after 8 minutes, or earlier when the child has finished.

The four criteria. Score each from 0 to 4; 1 and 3 fall between the descriptions. Total: 16 marks.

Criterion	0	2	4
Content and organisation	No English writing about the pictures, or only the frame words copied.	Writes about two or three of the pictures, in order, in phrases or short sentences.	Tells the whole story in order (all four pictures) with a clear ending, and adds a detail, a feeling or something a character says.
Vocabulary	No English words of the child's own.	Everyday words for the pictures (girl, flower, sun, water, sad, big).	Some precise or interesting words (seed, planted, watering can, hot, thirsty, droopy, grew, tall, taller than).
Grammar and sentences	No sentence.	Simple sentences, often without past tense or "a" and "the" ("She put seed. Flower is big.").	Correct simple sentences, past tense mostly right, some joined with and, but, because, so or when.
Spelling and punctuation	Letters or strings that cannot be read as words.	Common words mostly right; other words spelt as they sound (sunflowr, woterd, gru); some capital letters and full stops.	Most common words right, including common exception words (the, was, said, they); capital letters and full stops nearly always right; perhaps an exclamation mark or a question mark.

Checklist. Tick the writing checklist on the grading sheet (it includes whether the child uses Chinese characters or pinyin).

Writing band (best fit). Read the piece against the band descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide`, Section 6, and choose the band that fits best. Record the band on the grading sheet. The total is only a guide: about 0 to 3 **A**, 4 to 7 **B**, 8 to 10 **C**, 11 to 13 **D**, 14 to 16 **E**.

What band E looks like at this age. About five or more sentences that tell the whole story in order, mostly in the past tense, joined with words such as and, then, because and when; capital letters and full stops nearly every time; common words spelt correctly and harder words spelt so that they can be read; perhaps a feeling or a few words of speech. This is what a fluent English-speaking child at the end of UK Year 2 writes.

What to look for

- Missing past tense endings, plurals and "a" and "the" are normal for a learner of English: judge what the child can communicate.
- Spelling that uses pinyin letter values (for example "xi" for "she") shows the child is using sounds they know. Note it: it helps the teacher.
- Very slow, effortful handwriting, or letter formation that is also weak in Chinese (ask the parents), may point to a fine motor need. Note it on the Interview sheet.

3.5 Short interview and goodbye (8 minutes)

The questions are in `forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y3_Y4` and the record is the Interview sheet (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`). In Year 3 the sentence reading has already been done with the Early Reading Screen (Section 3.3), so do not repeat it in the interview. Choose about two questions from each block. Give the **speaking band** on the Interview sheet, using the picture talk (Section 3.1) and the interview together, and complete the suitability strands. To finish, thank the child and tell them one thing they did well. Do not give any results.

4. Maths (18 minutes, booklet pages 3 to 10)

Say: "Now we are going to do some maths. You can write in the booklet. I can read any question to you. Just ask me." Show the child Section A (number problems) and Section B (word problems and pictures).

- **Equipment:** pencil, rubber, ruler marked in cm. No calculator and no counters: the child may draw, or count on the pictures.
- **Reading aloud:** read any question in English as often as the child asks, slowly and clearly (see **Pace of speech** in Section 2), and point to the picture. Offer to read the word problems (Questions 7, 8 and 13) if the child does not ask. The Chinese reading is once only, by a colleague, after the English: write **L** (and list it on the grading sheet).

- **Time:** about 5 minutes for Section A and 13 minutes for Section B. If the child is stuck for about a minute, say: "Have a go, or we can go on to the next one." If they say they have not learnt something, write **NT** (and list it on the grading sheet).
- Questions 5 and 6b are Year 3 content, there to find the ceiling. A Year 3 entrant is not expected to get them.

Mark scheme. One mark for each answer unless the table says otherwise. Type: **N** number problem, **W** word problem, **P** problem with a picture or diagram.

Q	Type	Answer	Also accept	Notes: common errors; may not have been taught	Marks
				Section A: Number problems	
1	N	14; 12		Floor questions: Chinese Grade 1 work.	2
2	N	59; 45			2
3	N	83; 35		713 or 73 for the first: carrying not secure. 45 for the second: takes the smaller digit from the larger in each column (7 – 2 = 5).	2
4	N	20; 9		Multiplication and division may not have been taught (Chinese Grade 2). A child may still work them out by counting.	2
5	N	377		Year 3 content. Numbers above 100 may not have been taught (Grade 2).	1
				Section B: Word problems and pictures	
6	P	a 53; b 246		a: 35 (tens and ones swapped); 8 (counted the pieces). b: 200406 or 20046 (wrote each part) shows the parts are known but not place value. b is Year 3 content; numbers above 100 may not have been taught. Base 10 pictures may be new: Chinese classes use bundles of sticks and counting frames.	2
7	W	23	23 stickers	47 (added). Crossing out 12 stars and counting the rest is a good method.	1
8	W	20	20 dumplings	Counting every dumpling is fine. 9 (added 4 and 5) suggests the question was not understood: read it again. Multiplication may not have been taught.	1
9	P	7 cm	7	Centimetres and rulers may not have been taught (Grade 2).	1
10	P	6 sides and 6 vertices		Both needed for the mark. If the word "vertices" is the problem, say "corners": this is maths vocabulary, not a trick.	1
11	P	a 7; b 2		b: 8 (added 5 and 3) means "how many more" was not understood: a common English barrier. Read it again.	2
12	P	a half past 7; b twenty-five past 9	a 7:30, 7.30, seven thirty; b 9:25, 9.25, 25 past 9	a: 6:35 (hands swapped) or 8:30 (took the next number for the hour). b: 5:45 (hands swapped). Time to five minutes may not have been taught (Grade 2).	2
13	W	a ¥20; b ¥5	20, 20 yuan, 20元; 5, 5 yuan	b: 35 (added).	2
14	P	A straight vertical line through the tip of the arrow and the middle of the bottom edge	A freehand line, if it is clearly meant to be straight and goes through both points (within about 3 mm)	A horizontal line, or any other line, scores 0. Lines of symmetry may not have been taught (Grade 2).	1
15	P	a C only; b $^3/_4$	b: three quarters; 3 out of 4; 四分之三 (write L)	a: B (did not check that the parts are equal) or D (2 parts shaded). b: $^1/_4$ or $^4/_3$. Fractions may not have been taught (Grade 3).	2

Total: 24 marks (Section A, Questions 1 to 5: 9 marks; Section B, Questions 6 to 15: 15 marks), of which word problems (Questions 7, 8, 13a and 13b): 4 marks.

Band guide (provisional, to be reviewed after the first 20 to 30 candidates): 0 to 9 **1** Well below expected; 10 to 14 **2** Working towards; 15 to 20 **3** Expected; 21 to 24 **4** Greater depth. List the NT questions on the grading sheet. If they explain a low score, judge whether the child would reach band 3 once taught.

Number problems and word problems. Compare Questions 1 to 3 (adding and subtracting with no words) with Questions 7 and 13 (the same skills in words). A child who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an English barrier rather than a maths difficulty: check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L).

What to look for

- **Strong:** quick, accurate calculation; uses the pictures sensibly (crossing out stickers, counting the plates in fives); checks answers.
- **A maths difficulty:** errors on Questions 1 to 3 as well as on the word problems; counts in ones for everything; cannot read the ruler or the clock even when the question is read aloud.
- **An English barrier:** right answers to the number problems, but wrong or blank word problems that become right when read aloud or said in Chinese; asks for many questions to be read.

Likely not yet taught for a child who has completed Chinese Grade 1: Questions 4 and 8 (multiplication and division), 5 and 6b (numbers above 100), 9 (centimetre ruler), 12b (time to five minutes), 14 (symmetry) and 15 (fractions). Children from bilingual schools, or who have started Grade 2, may have met some of these.

5. Recording the results

1. Mark the student booklet the same day (every maths question has a mark box).
2. Copy the totals onto the grading sheet and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance).
3. Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet (the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; the sentence reading confirms it).
4. Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet before the interview.
5. After the interview, put together the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days.
6. File the marked student booklet with them (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 3 and 4

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y3_Y4`).

About 8 minutes in Year 3 and 12 minutes in Year 4, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**, as a friendly chat. It has three jobs: to hear the child's spoken English, to get to know the child (likes, school, friends, **hopes for the future**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. In Year 3 the sentence reading is done by the assessor, after the Early Reading Screen; in Year 4 the interview opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 4 minutes; start Level 3; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Sit beside the child. Have paper and crayons ready: some children talk more easily while drawing ("Draw something you love doing, and tell me about it"). Ask the main question first. If the child struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, a choice, or pointing). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak slowly and clearly: about 120 words a minute in Year 3 and about 130 in Year 4. Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and in Year 4 use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a child tells you something that worries you, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me about you.	What is your name? How old are you?	What makes you special?
	Who is in your family?	Do you have a brother or sister? A pet?	What do you like doing with your family?
School	Tell me about your school.	Do you like school?	What is the best thing about it?
	What is your favourite thing to learn? Why?	Do you like maths? Reading? Art?	What did you learn last week?
	What is hard for you at school? What do you do?	Is anything hard?	Who helps you?
	Do you read at home? Tell me about a book you like.	Do you like stories?	What happened in it?
Things I like	What do you like to do after school?	Do you like to play outside? Draw? Sport?	What are you best at?
	Do you have classes after school or at the weekend?	Do you go to classes on Saturday?	Do you like them?
Friends and feelings	Tell me about your friends.	Do you have a best friend? What is their name?	What do you play together?
	What makes you happy? What makes you sad?	Are you happy today?	What do you do when you are sad?
	How do you feel about a new school?	Happy, nervous, or both?	What would help you?
When I grow up	What do you want to be when you grow up?	Do you want to be a teacher? A doctor? Something else?	Why?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	What would you like to learn at our school?	Do you want to learn English? Sport? Music?	
Kindness	A child in your class is crying. What do you do?	Do you help them?	How can you help?
Questions for us	Do you want to ask me anything?		

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, for a child of this age, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the child is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	No English yet, or a few single words ("yes", "cat"). Uses Chinese, pointing or silence. Understands very little without pictures or gesture.
B Early acquisition	Single words, short phrases and some simple sentences ("I like football"). Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions with support.
C Developing competence	Answers in short sentences and can say a little more with prompting ("I like football because it is fun"). Errors are common; meaning is usually clear.
D Competent	Talks easily, joins ideas, tells a little story or explains, with occasional errors. Understands nearly everything said at a normal pace.
E Fluent	Speaks as a fluent English-speaking child of the same age would.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or what you saw.

Strand	What strong looks like at this age
Attitude to learning	Has a go, enjoys success, tries again after a mistake
Curiosity and engagement	Interested in the activities and pictures, asks questions
Social and emotional readiness	Separates from the parent and settles with a new adult, talks about friends, manages nerves
Independence	Follows two-step instructions, manages pencils and paper, can work alone for a few minutes
Kindness and conduct	Polite, shares, gives a kind answer to the kindness question
Readiness for learning in English	Happy to try English words, copies new words, not upset by not understanding

Boarding readiness (only if the child will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example speech and language, attention, hearing, vision, fine motor skills, pencil grip)
- Wellbeing (for example very anxious, tired, very heavy after-school workload)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the likely homeroom teacher meets the child, they note first impressions and what the child would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy, picture cards for routines, a quiet space) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Aim for about 120 words a minute in Years 1 and 2, 120 in Year 3, 130 in Year 4, 140 in Year 5, 155 in Year 6, 160 in Year 7, 160 in Year 8, 175 in Year 9 and 185 in Year 10. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.

Early Reading Screen: instructions

What it is. A one-to-one reading screen for children joining **Years 1 to 3**, and for an **older student who is new to English**. It shows where the child's **decoding** is (letter sounds, phonics, tricky words) and the **book band** they can read with understanding. It takes **about 10 to 12 minutes** at most; the start points keep it shorter for most children. All of it is in English: finding the child's level of English reading is one of its main purposes. The year group assessor instructions say where to start; the results go on the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`) and the final mark sheet.

What to print

- **Reading cards** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Cards`): once, in plastic sleeves. The child reads from these.
- **Instructions** (this guide, `Early_Reading_Screen_Guide`): once, for the assessor's folder.
- **Record sheets** (`Early_Reading_Screen_Record`, Sheets 1 to 13): one set for each child. You only need the running record sheets for the passages you use.

1. At a glance

Part	Cards	What the child does	About	Score
1 Letter sounds	1, 2	Says the sound of 26 single letters, then 18 letter groups (sh, ai, igh ...).	2 min	/ 26 and / 18
2 Phonics words	3 (practice), 4 to 7	Reads 40 words. **Section 1** (words 1 to 20): single letters, consonant digraphs, adjacent consonants (CVC, CCVC, CVCC). **Section 2** (words 21 to 40): vowel digraphs and trigraphs, split digraphs, two-syllable words. In each section 10 are real words and 10 are creature names (nonsense words).	3 min	/ 20 and / 20
3 Tricky words	8	Reads 20 common exception words: 10 from the Year 1 list and 10 from the Year 2 list.	1 min	/ 20
4 Passages	9 to 16	Reads two or three short stories aloud while you take a running record, then answers 3 or 4 questions on each.	4 to 6 min	book band
Total		Not every child does every part (Section 2).	**10 to 12 min**	

You need: the reading cards; one set of record sheets; a pencil; a watch; a plain card to cover lines if the child finds a full card too busy; a levelled book from the school's assessment set (optional, see 5.5).

2. Start points, stopping rules and timing

Where to start

Child	Start with	Then
Year 1 (age 5)	Letter sounds: Card 1, then Card 2 if 15 or more of Card 1 are right.	Section 1 (practice Card 3, then Cards 4 and 5). Section 2 (Cards 6 and 7) only if Section 1 is 15 or more. Tricky words (Card 8). Passages: see "Which passage first".
Year 2 (age 6)	Section 1, words 1 to 10 (practice Card 3, then Card 4).	**If words 1 to 10 are easy** (9 or 10 right, most read without sounding out): skip the letter sounds. Do words 11 to 20, then Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more, then the tricky words and passages. **If not:** finish Section 1 (and Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more), then do the letter sounds, the tricky words and the passages.
Year 3 (age 7)	Section 1, words 1 to 10.	**If easy:** go straight to Section 2 (skip words 11 to 20 and the letter sounds). Section 2 is 15 or more: go on to the passages. Section 2 is 12 to 14: tricky words, then passages. Section 2 is under 12: go back to words 11 to 20, then tricky words and passages. **If not easy:** as Year 2.
Older student new to English (age 8 or more)	Letter sounds (Cards 1 and 2) and Section 1.	Section 2 if Section 1 is 15 or more. Tricky words. Passages if Section 1 is 8 or more. Their reading band comes from their year group's reading paper; this screen shows where their decoding is, for planning.

Words skipped by a start rule are not scored: write "start rule" across them, and record the section as, for example, "10 / 10 on words 1 to 10, start rule".

Which passage first

Phonics result	First passage
Section 1 under 8	None. The book band is "not yet Pink". Stop after the tricky words.
Section 1 8 to 15	Passage 1, Pink (Card 9)
Section 1 16 or more, and Section 2 under 8 or not given	Passage 2, Red (Card 10)
Section 2 8 to 13	Passage 3, Yellow (Card 11)
Section 2 14 to 17	Passage 4, Light Blue (Card 12)
Section 2 18 or more	Passage 5, Green (Card 13). Year 3 and older: Passage 6, Orange (Card 14).

Moving between passages

- **A pass** is 90% accuracy or more **and** at least half the questions right (2 of 3, or 2 of 4).
- After a pass, give the next passage up. Stop at the first passage that is not a pass.
- If the first passage is not a pass, go down one passage (not below Passage 1).
- Use two or three passages. Give a fourth only if the child is keen and there is time.
- **The child's book band level is the highest passage passed.** Also note the highest passage read at 90% or more, if it is higher (decoding ahead of understanding, 6.3).

Stopping rules

Part	Stop when
Letter sounds	6 wrong in a row. Then say: "Look at the rest. Point to any you know." Mark the ones the child points to and says correctly.
Phonics words	5 wrong in a row in a section. The rest of that section scores 0.
Tricky words	5 wrong in a row.
A passage	The child goes past the "too hard" number of errors before the end, or is stuck on most lines. Say: "Thank you. You worked hard on that one." It is not a pass.
The whole screen	About 12 minutes, or the child is tired, upset or asks to stop. Record it on the summary sheet.

Timing

- Letter sounds about 2 minutes, phonics words about 3, tricky words about 1, passages and questions about 4 to 6.
- Write the start and finish times on the summary sheet (Sheet 13). Do not time the reading for a score; note it only if it is very slow.
- If the child is tiring, finish the passage you are on and stop. A short break and a return later is fine; record it.

3. Before you start

Setting up

- A quiet room. Sit side by side at a table. The card the child needs is in front of them; the record sheets are on a clipboard, out of the child's sight.
- Give this screen after the picture talk and listening (see the order of the day in the year group booklet). By then you have heard the child's spoken English, which helps you judge accent (4.4).
- Turn the cards yourself. Point to each item as the child reads it, or let the child point.

Access rules for this screen (the same in every year group)

- Say only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate, sound out, or read the cards or passages aloud.
- The child may ask for an instruction to be repeated in English. Repeat it as written.
- Everything is in English: letters, words and passages are read in English, and the answers to the questions about a passage must be in English. An answer in Chinese scores 0.
- Praise effort, never answers: "Thank you." "You are working hard." Do not say "good", "right" or "no" after a word.
- The child may stop a part when they have done what they can. Never push a distressed child: take a break or stop, and record it.
- Extra time or other arrangements for a known need: record them on the summary sheet.

Say at the start: "Now we are going to do some reading. Some of it is easy and some of it is hard. That is fine. Just do your best."

4. Marking conventions for learners of English

4.1 The main rule

> **Mark the reading, not the accent.** A word is right when a listener who can see the text would know which word the child said. Many children joining from Chinese schools speak English with features of Mandarin pronunciation. These are part of their spoken English, not reading errors, unless they change the word.

4.2 These are errors (each one counts 1)

Error	What the child does	Example	Mark
S Substitution	Says a different word, or a word that is not real.	"big" read as "bag"; "went" read as "want"; "strong" read as "string"	Write what the child said above the word.
O Omission	Leaves out a word, or leaves off an ending that is written (-s or -ed). This counts even if the child leaves endings off when they speak, as in the Graded Sentence Reading Screen; note the pattern.	"a big green kite" read as "a green kite"; "kicked" read as "kick"	Circle the word or ending.
I Insertion	Adds a word that is not there.	"on the mat" read as "on the big mat"	Write ^ and the added word.
T Told	Is stuck. You wait about 5 seconds, then say the word.		Write T above the word.

An error counts each time it happens, except a **name**: count a name error once in each passage, however often it comes.

4.3 These are not errors

Not an error	Example	Mark
SC Self-correction: the child reads a word wrongly, then puts it right.	"bag … big"	Write what was said, then SC.
R Repetition of a word or phrase.	"the cat … the cat is on the mat"	Underline the repeated words, write R.
Sounding out, then the right word.	"s-t-u-ck, stuck"	Nothing.
Pausing, reading slowly.		Nothing: it shows in the fluency rating.
l and r	"led" for red, "lain" for rain	acc
n and l	"nong" for long	acc
v and w	"wan" for van	acc
th said as s, f, d or z	"sank you" for thank you, "fink" for think, "dis" for this	acc
A dropped, quiet or unreleased final consonant sound, when the rest of the word is right (not a written ending such as -s or -ed: see Omission)	"be(d)", "do(g)", "stam(p)"	acc
A small vowel added after a final consonant	"bed-uh", "dog-uh", "kite-uh"	acc
The -ed ending said in full	"kick-ed" for kicked	acc
A short vowel said a little long or tense, when it is still clearly that vowel and the child gave the English sound on Card 1	"sit" a little like "seet"	acc
A name read in a Chinese or English way	Hao, Jun, Shanghai, Liu	Nothing.
A whole line missed (the child lost their place)		Point to the line: "Try this line." Mark the words as usual. The skip is not an error.

4.4 When you are not sure

Ask yourself two questions:

1. Would a listener who can see the text know which word the child said?
2. Does the child say this sound the same way when they talk (in the picture talk, for example)?

Two yeses: it is accent. Count it right and write **acc**. Otherwise count it as an error and write down what you heard. If you are still not sure, give the benefit of the doubt and make a note: patterns across many words are more useful than any one word.

4.5 Pinyin letter values (P)

A child who learnt pinyin may give an English letter its pinyin value. This is not guessing: the child is using a letter-sound system they know well. **Write P** above the letter or word, and what you heard.

Letters	English sound	Pinyin value the child may give	Example
i	short i, as in "sit"	"ee"	"sit" read as "seat"
u	short u, as in "up"	"oo"	"mub" read as "moob"
e	short e, as in "leg"	the pinyin e, like the vowel in "her"	"leg" read as "lerg"
o	short o, as in "on"	"aw" or "wo"	"dop" read as "dwop"
ai	as in "rain"	"eye"	"rain" read as "rine"
c	"k"	"ts"	"cake" read as "tsake"
x	"ks"	a soft "sh"	"x" said as "sh"; "six" read as "sish"
q, qu	"kw"	a soft "ch"	"qu" said as "chu"
z	"z"	"dz" or "ts"	"z" said as "dz"
j, r, h	as in "jam", "red", "hat"	close to the pinyin values	Accept: not P.
b, d, g, m and the other consonants	the sound alone	the sound with a vowel after it: "bo", "de", "ge" (from learning pinyin)	Accept: not P.

How P is scored

- **Letter sounds, phonics words and tricky words:** P scores 0, because the child did not give the English sound. Count the Ps separately: they show a working sound system that needs the English values (6.5).
- **Passages:** use the main rule. If the word is still clear in the sentence ("six eggs" read as "sish eggs"), it is not an error: write P only. If the word is not clear, it is an error: write P and what you heard.

4.6 Marks to use

Mark	Meaning	Counts as an error?
nothing, or a tick	read correctly	no
the word the child said, written above (S)	substitution	yes
circle (O)	omission	yes
^ and the word (I)	insertion	yes
T	told by you after about 5 seconds	yes
A	appeal: the child asked for help, and you said "Try it."	no, unless it ends in T
SC	self-correction	no
R	repetition	no
acc	accent feature; the word is clear	no
P	pinyin letter value	letters, phonics words, tricky words: yes. Passages: only if the word is not clear
N	letter name instead of the sound (letter sounds only)	yes
SO	sounds only: the child said the sounds but did not blend them (phonics words)	yes
RW	a creature word read as a real word ("blom" read as "bloom")	yes

5. Scripts and scoring

5.1 Letter sounds (Cards 1 and 2)

Card 1. Say: "Look at these letters. Tell me the sound each letter makes." Point to the first letter. "What sound does this one make?"

- Point to each letter in turn, along each row.
- **If the child says the letter name** (the first time only): "Yes, that is its name. What sound does it make?" After that, mark N for a name and move on.
- **If the child does not know** after about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one."
- **Stop** after 6 wrong in a row. Say: "Look at the rest. Point to any you know."

Card 2 (only if 15 or more right on Card 1). **Say:** "These letters go together. They make one sound. Tell me the sound." Point to each in turn.

Accept	Do not accept
The common English sound: a as in "ant", e as in "egg", i as in "ink", o as in "on", u as in "up"; c and k as "k"; g as in "go"; q as "kw" (or "k"); x as "ks"; y as in "yes". A consonant sound with a small vowel after it ("buh", "bo"). Accent features (4.3), such as v said close to w.	A letter name (N). A pinyin value (P). The sound of a different letter. A long vowel for a single vowel letter ("ay" for a): that is the name, mark N.
Card 2: sh as in "ship"; ch as in "chin"; th as in "thin" or "this" (a single s, f or d sound is accent: accept); ng as in "ring"; ck "k"; qu "kw"; ai as in "rain"; ee as in "see"; igh as in "night"; oa as in "boat"; oo as in "moon" or "book"; ar as in "car"; or as in "for"; ur as in "fur"; ow as in "cow" or "snow"; oi as in "coin"; ear as in "near"; air as in "fair".	Two separate sounds ("s-h", "o-a"). Letter names ("s, h"). A pinyin value ("ai" as "eye", mark P).

5.2 Phonics words (Cards 3 to 7)

Card 3 (practice). Point to **hat**. **Say:** "Now we are going to read some words. This is a real word. Can you read it?" If the child cannot, say: "It says hat."

Point to the big creature, then to **jop**. **Say:** "Look. This is a creature. This word has a creature next to it, so it is the creature's name. It says jop. Creature names are not real words."

Say: "Some words are real words. Some words are creature names. Read them the best you can."

Card 4. Say: "Now read these words to me. Start here." Point to word 1, then to each word in turn along each row (the grey numbers match the record sheet). Turn to Card 5 after word 10.

Card 6 (Section 2). **Say:** "Here are some more words. Some are real words and some are creature names. Read them the best you can."

- If the child says nothing for about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one." Do not tell the word.
- The child may sound out. Score the word they blend in the end. Write what the child said for every word that scores 0.

Scoring: 1 for each word read correctly. Accent features score 1 (4.3). Pinyin values (P), sounds only (SO) and creature words read as real words (RW) score 0. A real word must be read as that word. A creature word scores 1 for any reading that fits its letters, including these:

Creature word	Accept
thep	th as in "thin" or as in "this"
chulp	"ch" as in "chin"
jeek	rhymes with "seek"
toap	rhymes with "soap"
darp, sorp	with or without an r sound at the end of the vowel
choil	rhymes with "boil"
jeme	"jeem"
plome	rhymes with "home"
flape	rhymes with "tape"
lompid	"lom-pid", stress on either part
shoomit	"shoo-mit"; oo as in "moon" or as in "book"

5.3 Tricky words (Card 8)

Say: "These are words you might know. Read them to me." Point to each word in turn.

- If the child does not know after about 5 seconds: "That is fine. Next one."
- 1 for each word read correctly within about 5 seconds. Sounding out that ends with the right word is fine. A word sounded out as it is spelt ("was" read to rhyme with "has") scores 0.
- Stop after 5 wrong in a row.
- Words 1 to 10 are from the Year 1 list of common exception words and words 11 to 20 from the Year 2 list (English National Curriculum, spelling appendix).

5.4 Passages (Cards 9 to 16)

Each passage is matched to a book band and an Oxford Level (the levels used for Oxford Reading Tree books), so a real levelled book at the same level can be used in its place (5.5).

Passage	Card	Title	Book band	Oxford Level	Words	Independent: errors at most	Pass (90%): errors at most	Pass: questions at least
1	9	Where Is the Cat?	Pink	1+	23	1	2	2 of 3
2	10	At the Market	Red	2	36	1	3	2 of 3
3	11	The Kite	Yellow	3	57	2	5	2 of 4
4	12	A New Friend	Light Blue	4	79	3	7	2 of 4
5	13	The Lucky Dumpling	Green	5	99	4	9	2 of 4
6	14	The Fast Train	Orange	6	126	6	12	2 of 4
7	15	The Rabbit Lantern	Turquoise and Purple	7 to 8	151	7	15	2 of 4
8	16	The Drummer	Gold and White	9 to 10	178	8	17	2 of 4

1. Choose the first passage from Section 2. Put its card in front of the child.
2. **Say** the introduction printed on the passage's record sheet: the title and one sentence about the story. This is the only text you read aloud. The title does not count in the word count.
3. While the child reads, mark the running record (4.6). You do not need to tick every word: mark only what is different.
4. If the child stops or asks for help, say: "Try it." If the child is still stuck after about 5 seconds, say the word and mark T.
5. When the child finishes, **say:** "Thank you. Now I will ask you some questions about the story. You can look at the story." Ask each question as written. You may repeat a question once. If an answer is too short to judge, you may say once: "Tell me more."
6. Score the accuracy, self-corrections, fluency and questions on the sheet. Decide whether it is a pass and move up or down (Section 2).

Accuracy = (words minus errors) ÷ words × 100. Each sheet has the table already worked out.

Accuracy	Level	What it means
95% or more	Independent (Ind)	The child can read books at this band on their own.
90 to 94%	Instructional (Ins)	The right level for teaching, with support.
Below 90%	Too hard	Not a pass, whatever the questions show.

Self-correction rate = (errors + self-corrections) ÷ self-corrections, written as 1 : the answer. For example, 6 errors and 2 SC: 8 ÷ 2 = 4, so 1 : 4. A rate of 1 : 3 or better (1 : 1, 1 : 2, 1 : 3) shows a child who checks their reading. No SC: write "none".

Fluency (rate the whole passage)

Rating		What it sounds like
1	Word by word	One word at a time, with long pauses. No sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Some phrasing	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word by word. Little attention to punctuation. Little expression.
3	Mostly phrased	Reads in sensible phrases and mostly follows full stops and commas. Some pauses to work out harder words.
4	Fluent and expressive	Smooth and close to natural speech. Follows punctuation. The voice changes for questions and for what characters say.

Questions: 1 mark each. The child may look back at the story. Accept answers in the child's own words, one word, or a short phrase; grammar mistakes do not matter. Pointing counts only where the question asks the child to show. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

Book band level = the highest passage read at **90% or more** with **at least half the questions** right.

5.5 Using a real levelled book instead

- You may use a real levelled book at the same band instead of a passage, for example an Oxford Reading Tree book from the school's assessment set. The book list is in `01_Reading_Books_and_Materials.md`.
- Choose a book the child has not read. Ask: "Have you read this book before?"
- Use the same method: introduce it with the title and one sentence, then use the same marks, error rules, accuracy levels, self-correction rate and fluency scale.
- Pink to Yellow: use the whole book. Light Blue and above: use a section of about 100 to 150 words, and count the words before you start.
- Use **Sheet 12**. Before you start, write 3 or 4 questions (literal, inference, vocabulary, and prediction or personal response) and the answers you expect. A pass is the same: 90% or more and at least half the questions.
- Write the book's title, band and Oxford Level on the summary sheet.

6. What the results mean

6.1 Is decoding secure?

Result	What it suggests
Card 1: 24 or more / 26; Card 2: 15 or more / 18	Letter-sound knowledge is secure.
Card 1: 10 to 23	Partly secure. List the letters missed: they show what to teach first.
Section 1: 16 or more / 20	Blending is secure with single letters, consonant digraphs and adjacent consonants.
Section 1: under 12	Blending is not yet secure. The child needs phonics teaching from the early stages.
Section 2: 14 or more / 20	Vowel digraphs and split digraphs are mostly secure.
Section 1 secure, Section 2 under 10	Single letters and blends are secure; vowel digraphs and split digraphs are not yet. Typical of a fluent English reader partway through Reception.
Both sections secure	Decoding is secure for Key Stage 1 phonics. The next limit is vocabulary and understanding: look at the passages.
Tricky words: 8 or more of the Year 1 words (or of the Year 2 words)	The common exception words for that year are known by sight.

6.2 Real words and nonsense words

- **Real words much higher than nonsense words** (3 or more higher in a section): the child may be reading known words by sight, or guessing from the first letter. Decoding of new words is weaker than it looks. Check the passages for guesses that fit the picture or the meaning but not the letters.

- **Nonsense words about the same as, or higher than, real words:** decoding is working. Low real-word scores then often mean the child does not know these English words, so they cannot check them against meaning: a vocabulary gap, not a phonics gap.
- **Many RW** (creature words turned into real words): the child expects reading to make sense, which is good, but does not yet trust their decoding.
- **Many SO** (sounds only): the child knows the sounds but cannot yet blend them. Teach blending.

6.3 Decoding and understanding

Pattern	What it suggests	What to record
Accuracy 95% or more, but fewer than half the questions right	**Decoding ahead of understanding.** The child can say the words but does not yet understand enough English. Common in children taught phonics in after-school classes.	The book band level is the level with understanding. Also record "decodes at" the highest passage read at 90% or more. The need is vocabulary and spoken English.
Accuracy below 90%, but most questions right	**Understanding ahead of decoding.** Spoken English and meaning are strong; decoding is behind. Often a child from a bilingual school taught whole words, or a confident speaker who uses the pictures and the meaning.	The book band level is lower than the child's understanding. The need is systematic phonics; progress is often quick.
Low accuracy and few questions right	The passage is too hard.	The level below is the book band level.

6.4 Vocabulary gaps

- The child reads a word correctly but cannot say what it means (a vocabulary question wrong).
- Substitutions that look like the word but do not make sense ("strong" read as "string", "shiny" read as "shy").
- Note the words the child did not know. They show what to teach, and they are evidence for the reading band.

6.5 Patterns typical for children who learnt pinyin

- **Strong blending of short words:** pinyin is spelt sound by sound, so blending transfers well.
- **Pinyin vowel values:** i as "ee", u as "oo", e as the pinyin e, ai as "eye" ("rain" read as "rine").
- **Pinyin consonant values:** c as "ts", q as "ch", x as "sh", z as "dz".
- **A vowel added to consonant sounds** ("bo", "de"), from the way pinyin is taught. Not an error.
- **Letter names known, sounds not known** (many N marks): the child learnt the alphabet song but not phonics.
- **Split digraphs and silent letters are new:** pinyin has no silent letters, so "cake" may be read as "cak" or "ca-ke".
- **English vowel digraphs** (ee, oa, oo, igh) are new, and may be read as two sounds.
- **Final consonants dropped or softened:** Mandarin syllables end only in a vowel, n or ng. This is accent (4.3).
- These children already know that letters stand for sounds, so they usually respond well to direct teaching of the English values.

6.6 Book bands: what a fluent English reader usually reads

These are **Oxford's guide figures for fluent English readers** (Oxford levelling guidance: end of Reception Oxford Level 3, end of Year 1 Level 6, end of Year 2 Level 10, end of Year 3 Level 13). Oxford says the chart is a guide only, and schools vary. **Most children joining from Chinese schools will read below these bands at entry. That is expected**, and it is what the A to E band in 6.7 takes into account: the band describes how far the child's English reading has come, compared with these figures.

Point in the school year	Age (about)	Book band	Oxford Level	Phonics on this screen
Start of Year 1	5	Yellow	3	Letter sounds and Section 1 mostly secure; some of Section 2
Start of Year 2	6	Orange	6	Sections 1 and 2 mostly secure
Start of Year 3	7	White	10	Secure; tricky words known
Start of Year 4	8	Lime and above	11 and above	Secure. Beyond the top of this screen (Passage 8 is Gold and White).

Oxford Levels and book bands, for matching a real book: 1 Lilac, 1+ Pink, 2 Red, 3 Yellow, 4 Light Blue, 5 Green, 6 Orange, 7 Turquoise, 8 Purple, 9 Gold, 10 White, 11 Lime.

6.7 Band guide: the reading band A to E

Use the column for the year group the child is joining. "Passage" means the book band level: the highest passage passed (5.4). Band E means comparable to a fluent English reader of the same age, so it is set at the Oxford figures in 6.6.

Reading band	Age 5, joining Year 1 (fluent readers: about Yellow)	Age 6, joining Year 2 (fluent readers: about Orange)	Age 7, joining Year 3 (fluent readers: about White)
A New to English	Fewer than 10 letter sounds; reads no words.	Fewer than 10 letter sounds, or fewer than 4 Section 1 words.	Fewer than 8 Section 1 words; no passage.
B Early acquisition	10 or more letter sounds; reads 1 to 9 Section 1 words.	4 or more Section 1 words but no passage; or Passage 1 (Pink).	8 or more Section 1 words but no passage; or Passage 1, 2 or 3 (Pink, Red, Yellow).
C Developing competence	Section 1: 10 or more but no passage; or Passage 1 (Pink).	Passage 2 or 3 (Red, Yellow).	Passage 4 or 5 (Light Blue, Green).
D Competent	Passage 2 (Red).	Passage 4 or 5 (Light Blue, Green).	Passage 6 or 7 (Orange; Turquoise and Purple).
E Fluent	Passage 3 (Yellow) or above.	Passage 6 (Orange) or above.	Passage 8 (Gold and White).

- **E also needs reading that sounds fluent for the age:** fluency 3 or 4 and most of the questions right at that level. If not, give D.
- **Best fit, not a formula.** If the results are uneven (for example Passage 4 passed with very few letter sounds known), use judgement and say why in the notes. Check against the Graded Sentence Reading Screen and the listening and speaking bands.
- **Joining later in the school year:** expect a little more for D and E, about one passage higher by the second half of the year.
- **An older student new to English:** this screen only finds the floor. As a guide: below Pink, A; Pink to Yellow, B; Light Blue to Orange, C. If they pass Passage 7 or 8, their band comes from the year group's reading paper. Use the letter sound and phonics results to plan teaching.